



Thermal Properties 2

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Thermal expansion

Materials change size with change of temperature



$$T_{\text{final}} > T_{\text{initial}}$$



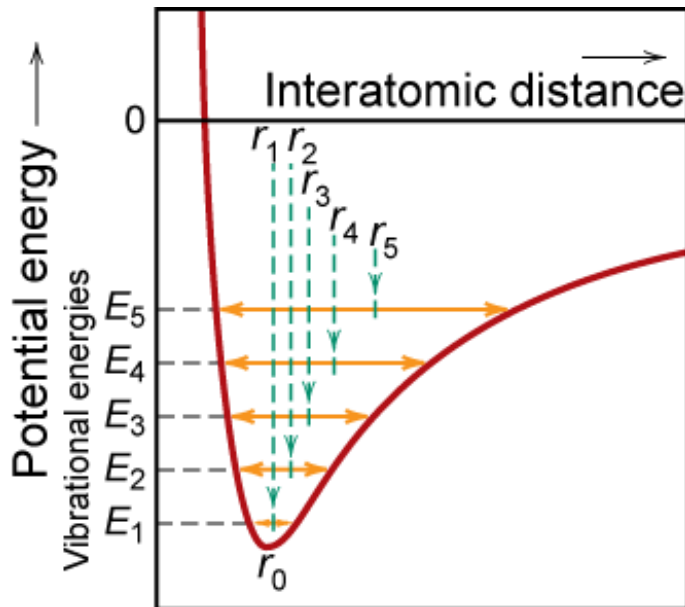
$$\frac{l_{\text{final}} - l_{\text{initial}}}{l_{\text{initial}}} = \alpha_l (T_{\text{final}} - T_{\text{initial}}) \quad \text{or} \quad \frac{\Delta l}{l_0} = \alpha_l \Delta T$$

α_l = linear coefficient of thermal expansion (**CTE**)
units of 1/K

Anisotropic materials can have different CTE in different directions

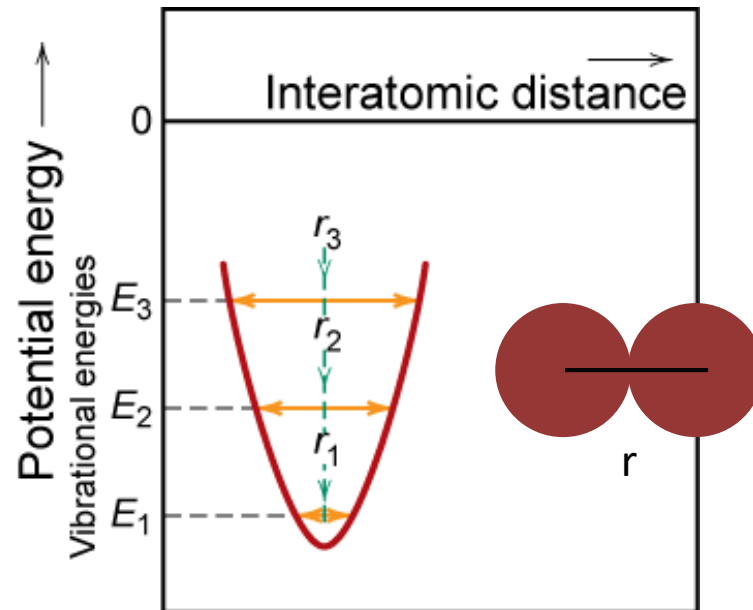
Thermal expansion

Atomic scale: interaction potential between atoms



Asymmetric curve:

- increase temperature,
- increase in interatomic separation
- thermal expansion



Symmetric curve:

- increase temperature,
- no increase in interatomic separation
- no thermal expansion

Thermal expansion

Material α_ℓ ($10^{-6}/\text{K}$)
at room T

- Polymers

Polypropylene	145-180
Polyethylene	106-198
Polystyrene	90-150
Teflon	126-216

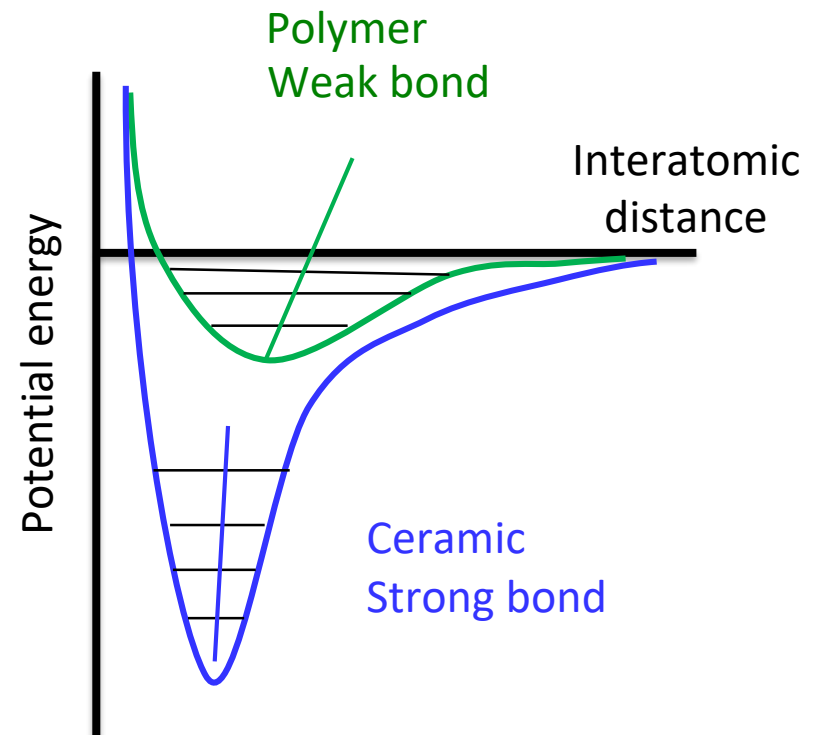
Polymers have larger α_ℓ values
because of weak secondary bonds

- Metals

Aluminum	23.6
Steel	12
Tungsten	4.5
Gold	14.2

- Ceramics

Magnesia (MgO)	13.5
Alumina (Al_2O_3)	7.6
Soda-lime glass	9
Silica (cryst. SiO_2)	0.4



Thermal expansion



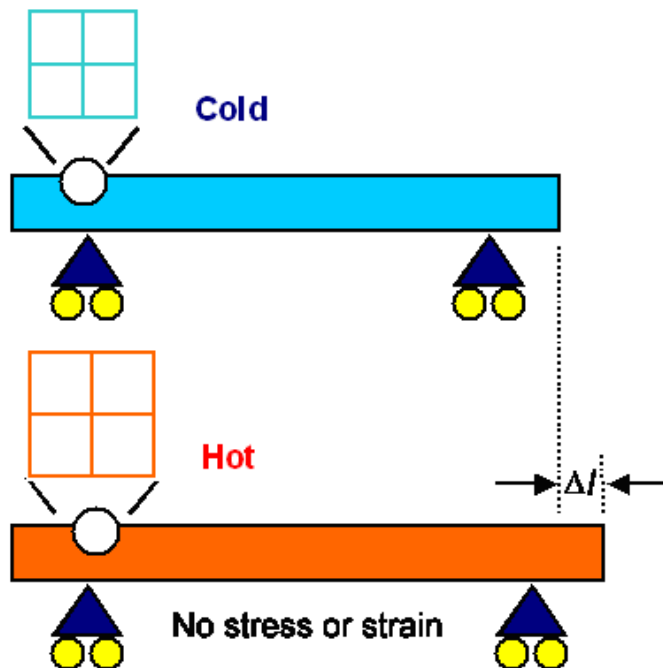
Space is left between railway tracks as an allowance for their expansion when temperature increases, otherwise the rails may buckle.



Thermal stresses

Free to expand

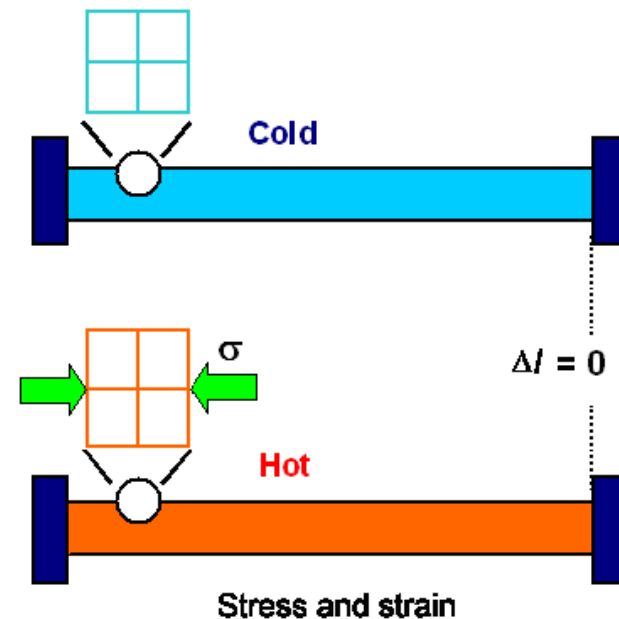
Material extends on heating by Δl



**Thermal cycling
can lead to thermal fatigue failure**

Restrained

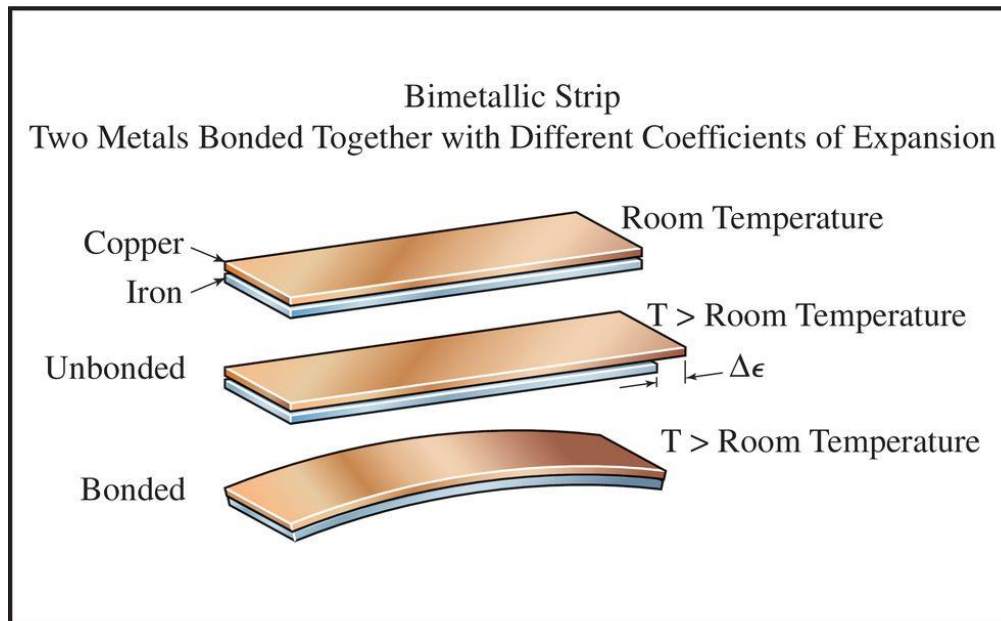
Material becomes stressed on heating



If **heating** $\sigma < 0$, compressive
If **cooled** $\sigma > 0$, tension

Differential thermal expansion

Bi-metal strip – 2 metals with different CTE bonded together



Misfit strain $\Delta\epsilon = (\alpha_1 - \alpha_2)\Delta T$

Radius of curvature, R

$$\frac{1}{R} = \frac{12\Delta\epsilon}{h(E_1/E_2 + 14 + E_2/E_1)}$$

where

E = elastic modulus

h = thickness of strip

(same for both metals)

1 and 2 are the two different metals

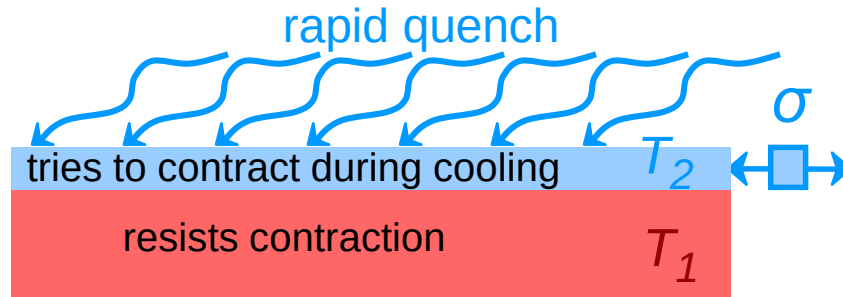
Used for temperature measurement

Temperature dependent switch (thermostat)

Thermal distortion – change in shape

Thermal shock

Rapid cooling can cause large stresses to be generated



Tension develops at surface

$$\sigma = -E\alpha_{\ell}(T_1 - T_2)$$

Temperature gradient and thermal conductivity combine with thermal expansion to generate large stresses

Tensile stresses at the surface can cause cracks (and fracture, σ_f)

The temperature gradient for failure is given by:

Thermal shock resistance $(TSR) \propto \frac{\sigma_f k}{E\alpha_{\ell}}$

Thermal shock

Rapid cooling can cause large stresses to be generated in materials with low thermal conductivity

Examples:

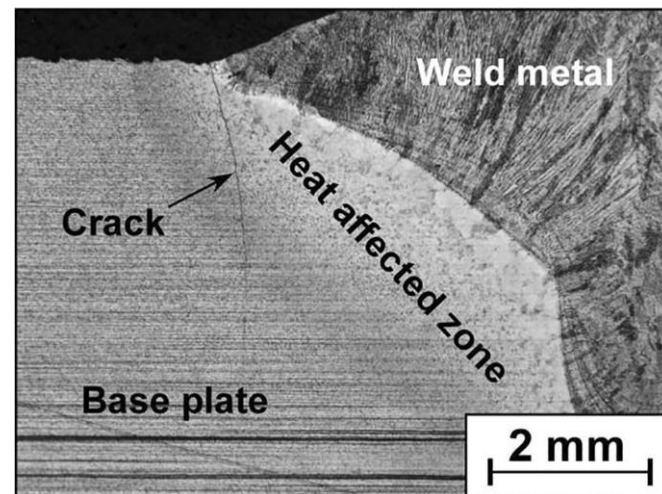
- **Heat treatment of metals**
 - maximum cooling rate (quenching)
 - maximum diameter of metal

$$(TSR) \propto \frac{\sigma_f k}{E \alpha_\ell}$$

- **Cooling of ceramics**
 - fracture to make glass powder (frit)

$$(TSR) \propto \frac{K_{IC} k}{E \alpha_\ell}$$

- **Welding** in low k steels
 - fracture in cooling zone leads to fatigue failure



Applications of thermal properties

- Thermal management



- Photos: Application of ceramic coating Super-therm™

Applications of thermal properties

- Thermal conductivity

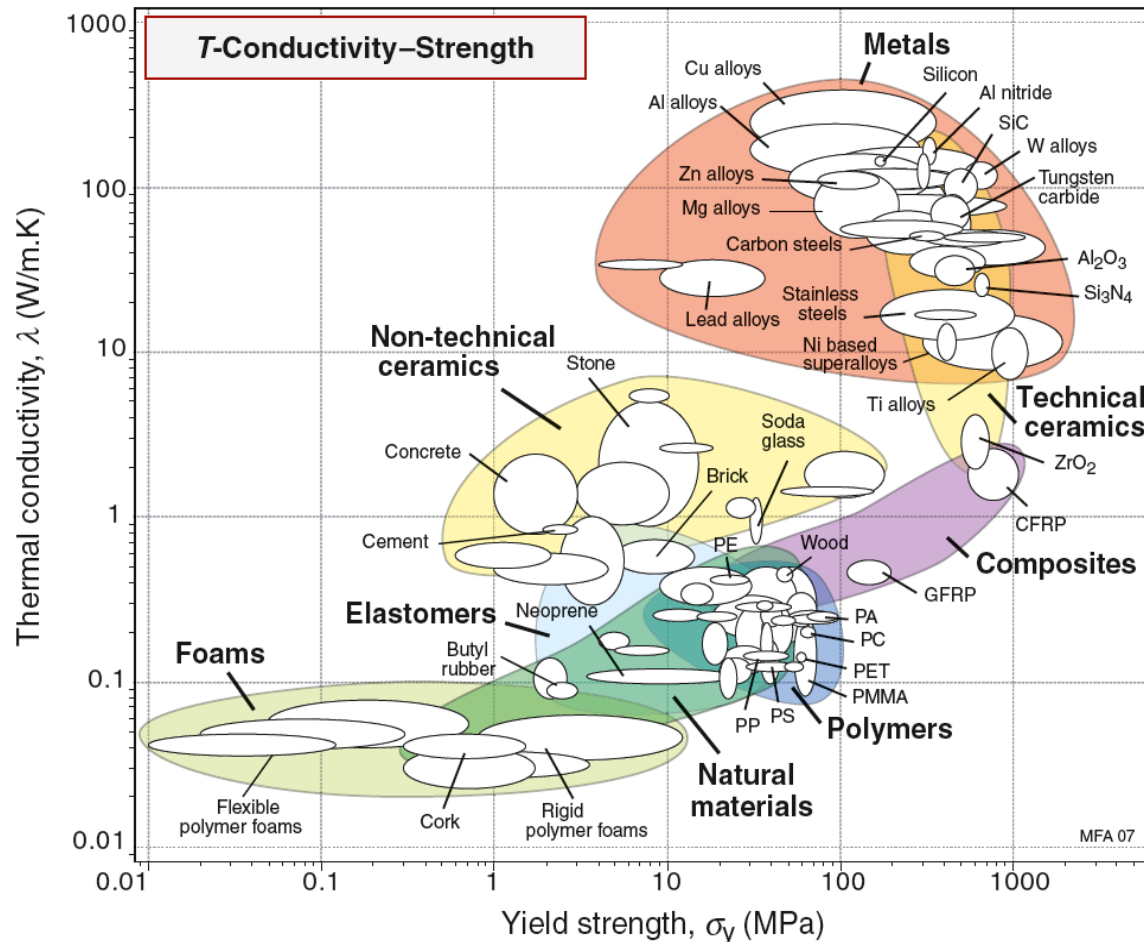


Figure 12.6

- Many applications require a combination of high strength and high conductivity
- Cu and Al are strong and good conductors, used in heat exchangers

Applications of thermal properties

- Thermal diffusivity

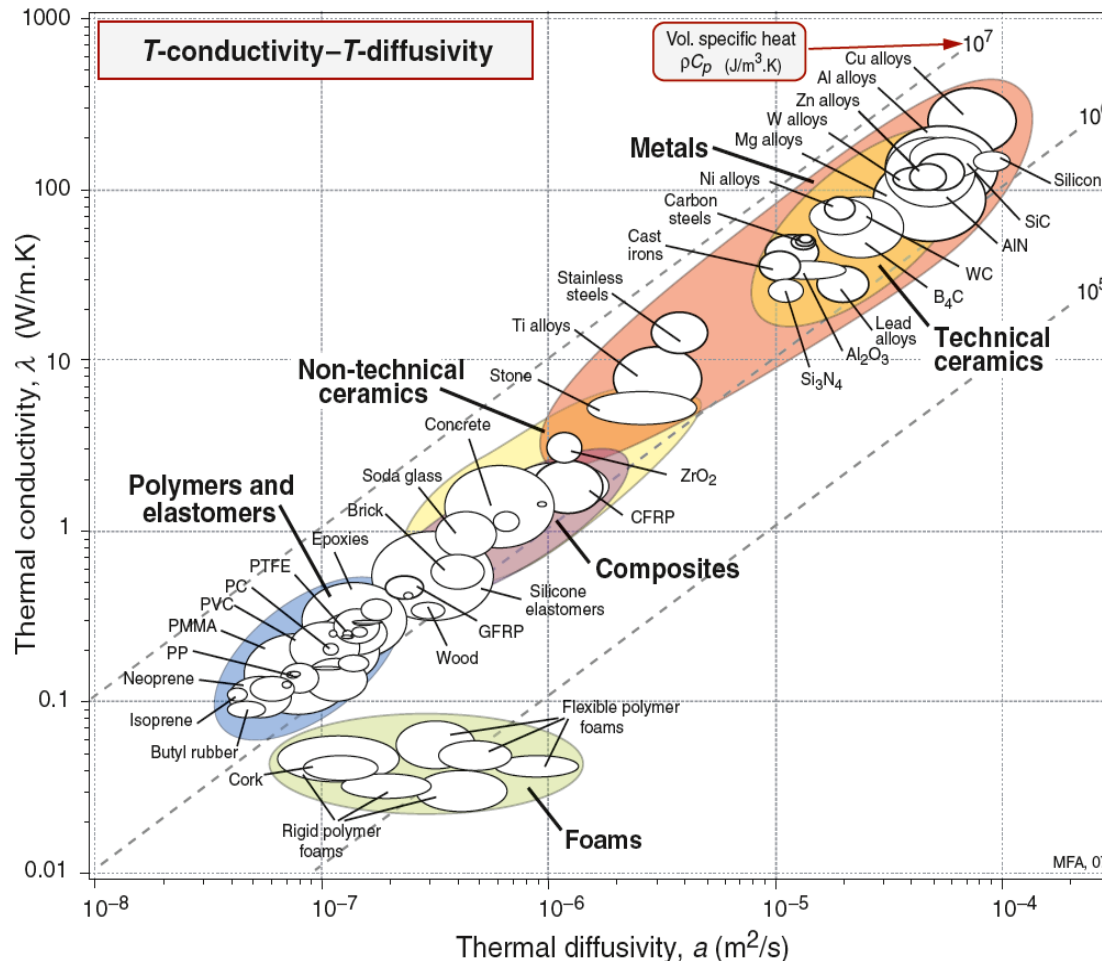


Figure 12.5

- Contours show the specific heat per unit volume
- Good conductors are located in the upper right
- Good insulators are found in the lower left
- E.g. foams are used for insulation because of their lower conductivities

Applications of thermal properties

• Thermal distortion

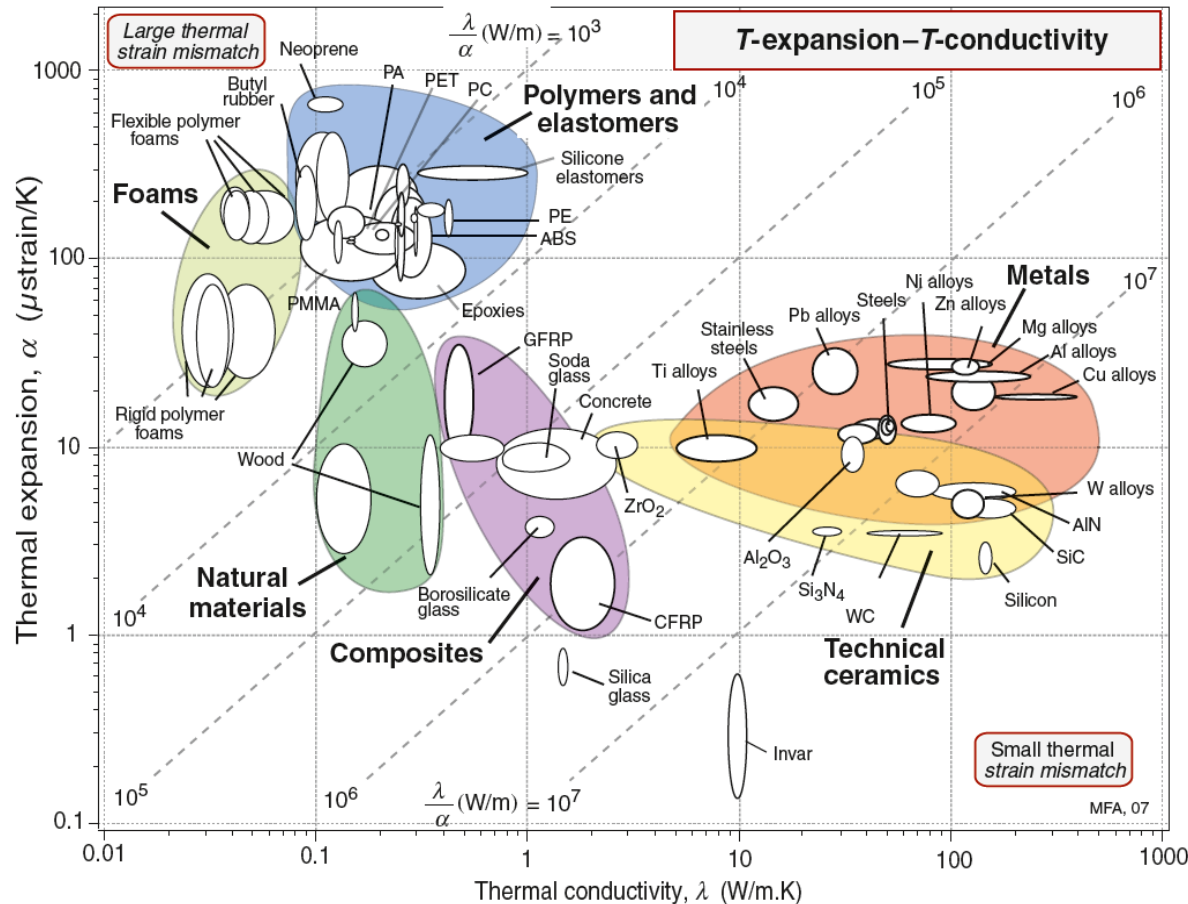


Figure 12.4

- Thermal distortion is a problem in fabrication
- Application of coatings is a typical issue, materials cool down at different rates
- Selecting materials that have similar thermal expansion coefficients from the chart

Thermo-mechanical behaviour:

- Coefficient of thermal expansion (CTE)
- Thermal stresses with temperature difference
- Thermal distortion
- Thermal shock
- Selection of materials for thermal applications

Learning outcomes

Thermal properties important in materials processing:

- Heat capacity
- Heat conduction
- Thermal expansion and contraction

Thermal properties important in materials applications:

- Thermal management – thermal diffusivity
- Thermal stresses
- Expansion
- Thermal cycling
- Thermal shock